AMANDI & THARINDU · WEDDING WEBSITE

Sending Guest Messages

A simple, step-by-step guide to the Message Center — what to press, in what order, and why.



For the admin who sends the WhatsApp messages.
No technical skill needed. Every screenshot in this guide is from the real website (shown with sample guests, so your own list will have your own names).

START HERE

Three things to know first



You press Send

The website never sends anything by itself. It opens WhatsApp with the message already typed. **You** press Send, from **your own** WhatsApp.



Use your phone

On a computer or WhatsApp Web, emoji like 💍 can turn into "". The phone app shows them correctly.



One per invitation

A family has **one code and one number**. Send each message once per family, not once per person.

What you need on your phone

- An **Android phone or iPhone** with the **WhatsApp app**, signed in with **your own number**, and kept up to date.
- A phone browser (**Chrome** on Android, **Safari** on iPhone) and an internet connection.
- Sign in to the admin site on the phone: your website address followed by `/admin`. Then open **Messages**.
- **Pop-ups allowed** for the site in the browser settings. If they are blocked, the Open in WhatsApp button does nothing.
- Do your sending on the **Messages** page. It fits a phone screen. The Guests page is a wide table and needs sideways scrolling.

How it works on the phone

Press **Open in WhatsApp** → the WhatsApp app opens with that guest's chat and the message ready → press **Send** → go back to the browser → press ✔ **Mark as sent**. If the phone asks which app to use, choose **WhatsApp**.

Check before you send

Look at the message in WhatsApp. If you see "" where an emoji should be, do **not** send. Go back, press **Copy message**, and paste the text into the chat instead. Pasting keeps every emoji.

THE PLAN

The 4 messages every guest gets

Send them in this order. The website calls each one a **level**, and tracks them with ticks.

STEP 1 OF 4

Main invitation

The invitation and the website link. **No code** inside.

Goes to everyone

STEP 2 OF 4

Guest code

Only the guest's personal RSVP code, in its own message.

Goes to everyone

STEP 3 OF 4

RSVP reminder

A gentle nudge to reply.

Only "Pending"

STEP 4 OF 4

Table number

Where they will sit.

Accepted + seated

The website picks the right audience for each step automatically. You can change it if you need to.

Why the code goes in a separate message

The code is the guest's private key to the RSVP page. If the invitation and the code were in one message, a guest could forward it to a friend, and the friend could use the code too.

Step 1 · Main invitation

"...view your invitation at the link. **Your code will follow in a separate message.**"

→

A guest forwards it to a friend

The friend gets the link but **× no code**, so cannot RSVP as your guest.

Step 2 · Guest code

"Your personal RSVP code is: **FRI-NA-731**. Please keep it private."

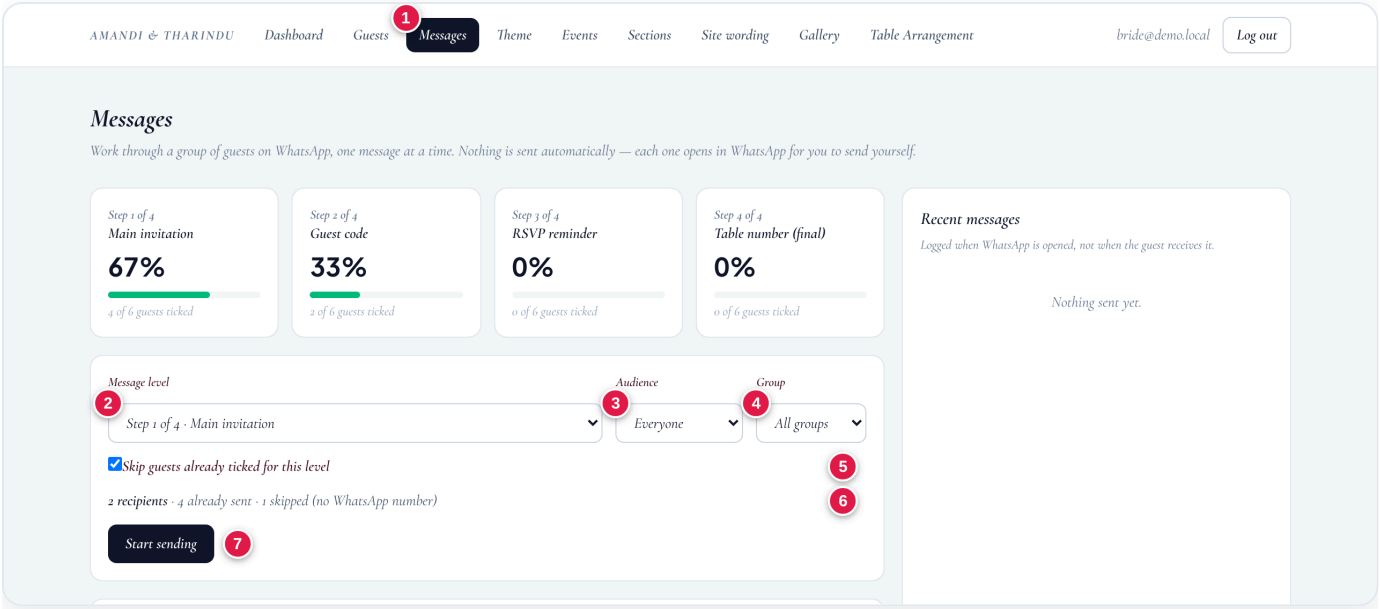
Always send Step 1 first, then Step 2 straight after.

Do not send the code before the invitation. And never post a guest's code in a group chat.

Suggested order for the whole wedding

When	What to do
First	Step 1 · Main invitation → to everyone. Mark each as sent.
Straight after	Step 2 · Guest code → to everyone. Before sending, check the guest's ticks show `✓ Step 1` (see "Step 2 · Guest code" below).
1–2 weeks later	Step 3 · RSVP reminder → the audience is already "Pending RSVP", so people who replied are left out.
When seating is finished	Step 4 · Table number → only to guests who accepted and are seated.

THE SCREEN The Messages page, step by step



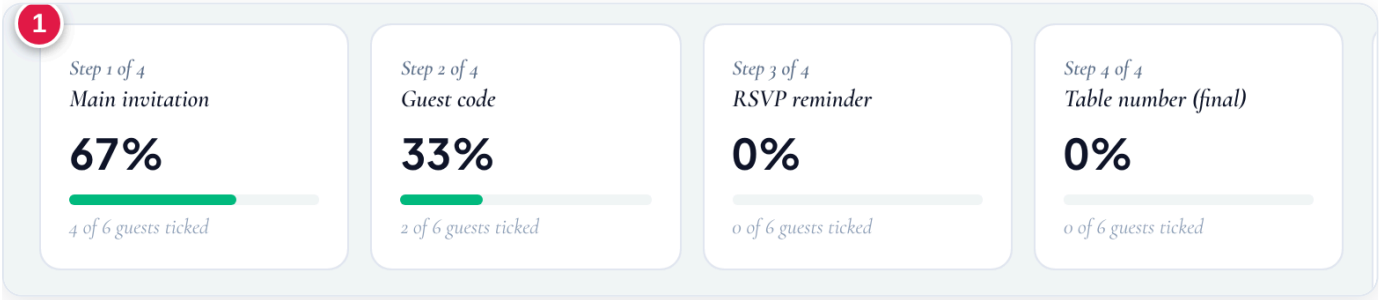
The Messages page (real screenshot, sample guests)

1. Open **Messages** in the top menu.
2. **Message level:** pick Step 1, 2, 3 or 4.
3. **Audience:** fills in by itself (Everyone, Pending, Accepted...).
4. **Group:** optional. Send to one group at a time, like Friends.
5. Keep **"Skip guests already ticked"** switched on, so nobody gets the same message twice.
6. The **count line** tells you who is on the list (see below).
7. Press **Start sending** when it looks right.

Reading the count line

2 recipients	People you are about to message.
4 already sent	Already ticked for this level, so they are hidden from the list.
1 skipped (no WhatsApp number)	No number saved. Go to **Guests → Edit** and add one, then they appear.
1 waiting for a table	Step 4 only. This guest is not seated yet, so they are left out for now.

The progress cards



One card per step shows how far you have got. Use them to see what is left.

SENDING Sending to each guest

After you press **Start sending**, the first guest appears. Do the same three things for every guest:

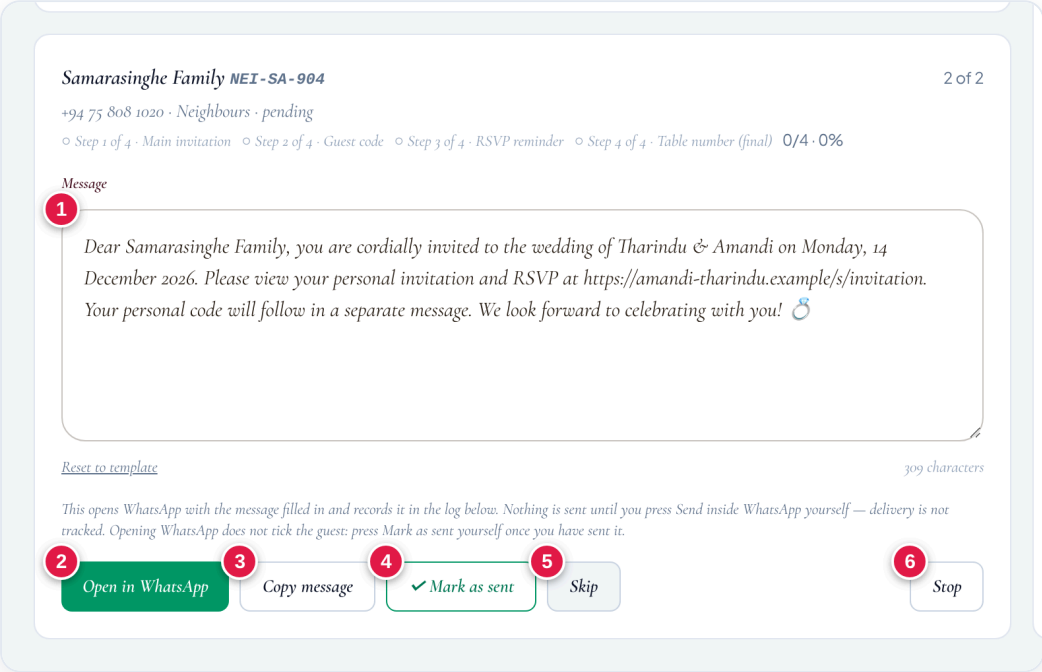
1. Open in WhatsApp
WhatsApp opens with the message ready

→

2. Press Send
Inside WhatsApp, yourself

→

3. ✓ Mark as sent
Back on the website. It ticks the guest and moves to the next one



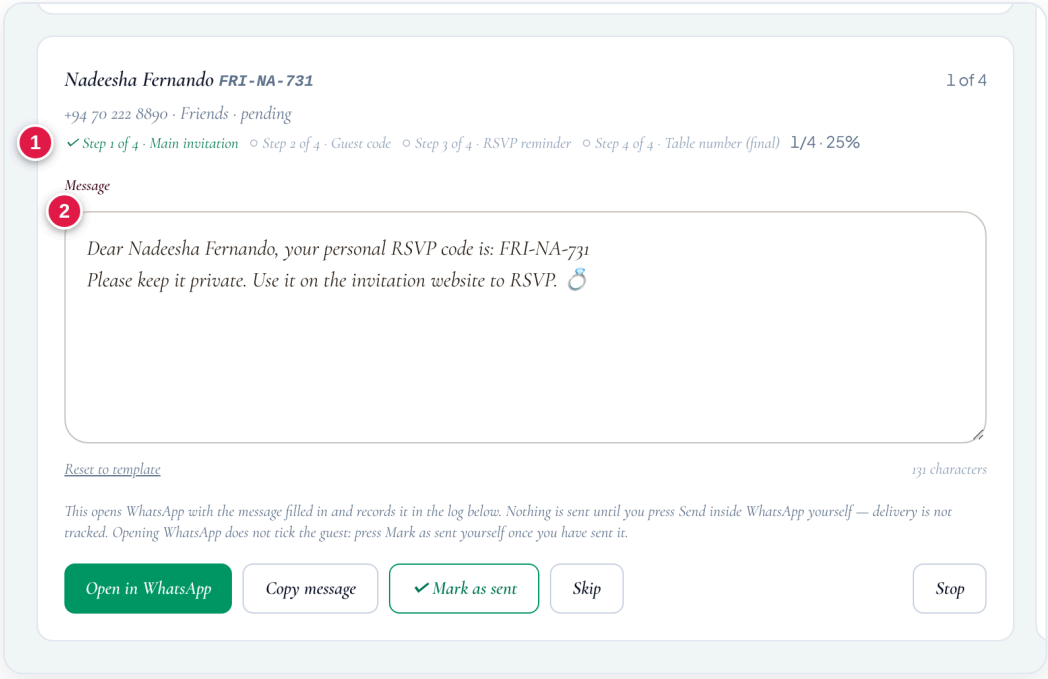
A guest's card during a run. Here: the Step 1 invitation for a family.

1. The **message**, already filled in with the guest's name. You can edit it for this one guest.
2. **Open in WhatsApp** opens the chat with their number.
3. **Copy message** copies the text so you can paste it yourself (use if emoji look broken).
4. **✓ Mark as sent** ticks the guest and goes to the next.
5. **Skip** moves on *without* ticking (not ready for this guest).
6. **Stop** ends the run. Your ticks are saved.

> **Opening WhatsApp does not tick the guest.**
> Only **✓ Mark as sent** does. If you forget, the guest shows up again next time. A tick means "I sent it". It does not prove the guest received it.

When you reach the end you will see "That is everyone in this group." Pop-up blocked? Allow pop-ups for the site and try again.

STEP 2 The guest code message



Step 2 for one guest. The message carries only their code.

1. **Check the ticks line first.** It shows what this guest already has. Before sending the code, you want ✓ **Step 1** here. If it is empty, send them Step 1 first.
2. The message holds the guest's own code.

> **Why this check matters**
> Step 2 lists everyone not yet ticked for *Step 2*, even if they have not had Step 1. The ticks line is how you catch that.

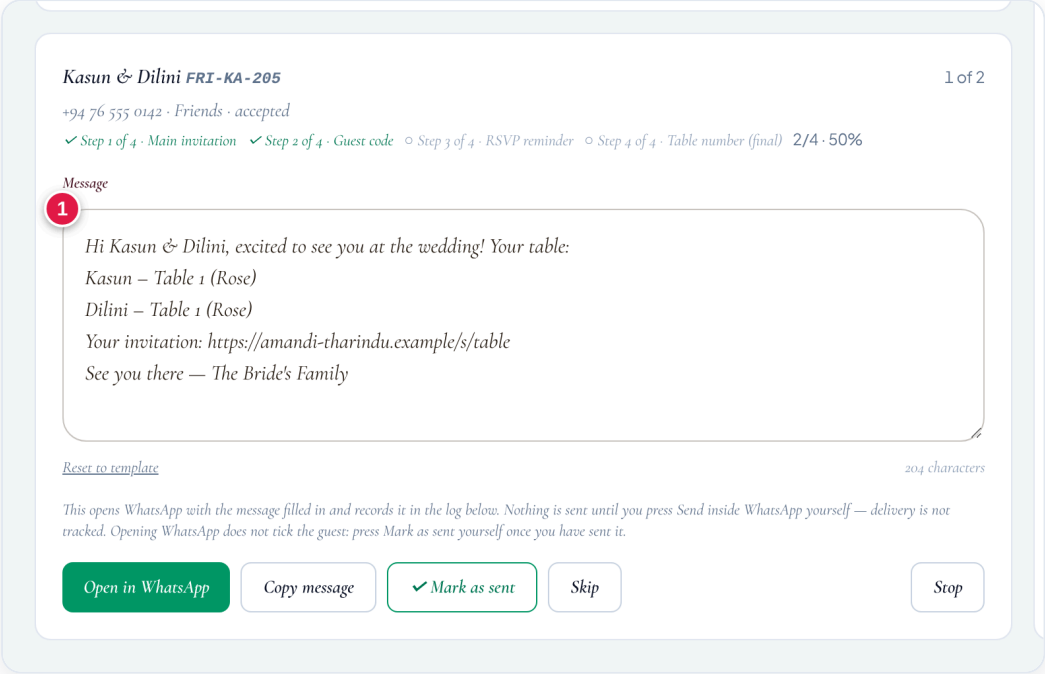
STEP 3 & 4 Reminder and table number

Step 3 · RSVP reminder

Send this a week or two after the invitation. The audience is already set to **Pending RSVP**, so guests who have replied are left out. It works exactly like Step 1: Start sending → Open in WhatsApp → Send → ✓ Mark as sent.

> **This one repeats the code**
> The reminder includes the guest's code again, so they do not have to scroll back to find it. That is fine for a reminder to the guest themselves, but remember that it should not be forwarded either.

Step 4 · Table number



Step 4 for a couple. Each person is listed with their own table, filled in automatically.

Only guests who accepted *and* are seated appear here. Everyone else shows as "waiting for a table".

FAMILIES & COUPLES

When one invitation has many people

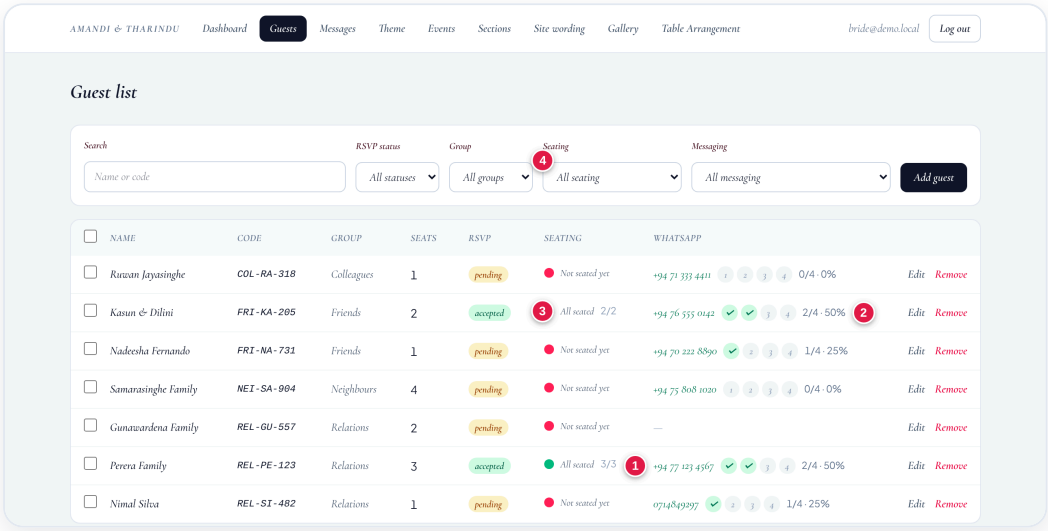
An invitation like **Perera Family** is **one** invitation, not three:

One name	One code	One number	Many people
Perera Family	REL-PE-123	+94 77 123 4567	Nimal, Kamala, Sunil

The right way

Send each step **once**, to the number saved on that invitation. Ask that person to tell the rest of the family. The message says “Dear Perera Family”, which is correct. Do not message each member separately.

Wait for “All seated” before Step 4



The Guests page. Real screenshot, sample guests.

1. **Click the guest’s number** to open their message pop-up.
2. The small circles 1–4 show the four steps. A green ✓ means sent.
3. **Seating column:** wait for **“All seated”** before sending Step 4.
4. Use the **Seating filter** to see who is still partly or not seated.

Why wait?

A family gets the Step 4 message as soon as *one* person is seated, and the message would list only the people seated so far. Waiting for “All seated” means you send it once.

To change which number a family receives messages on: Guests → Edit → WhatsApp number. To see who is in the family: Edit → “People in this party”. **Friends who share one code but each have their own phone? See the next two pages.**

SHARED CODE · SEPARATE PHONES

One code, many people: the manual method

Example: **Hydromony Friends** are 5 or 6 office friends. They share **one code**, so they can all see each other on the RSVP page. But each has **their own WhatsApp number**, and each should get a message with **their own name**.

NOT BUILT YET · DEVELOPER WORK NEEDED

The website saves **one WhatsApp number per invitation**. The people inside it have names only, no numbers. So the Messages page can open WhatsApp for just **one** person in the group, and the greeting says the group name ("Dear Hydromony Friends"). Until it is improved (see the end of this section), send to the rest **by hand**, as below.

What the message looks like

What the website fills in

"Dear **Hydromony Friends**, you are cordially invited..."

→

What you send to each person

"Dear **Samira**, you are cordially invited..."

Step by step, for each person in the group

Do one message level at a time (all of Step 1, then all of Step 2...), not person by person across all four levels.

1. **Find the people.** Guests → **Edit** on the group → **People in this party**. Write the names and their phone numbers on the tracker (next page).
2. **Start the run** as usual (Messages → pick the level → Start sending) until the group's card appears.
3. **Change the name in the message box.** Replace "Hydromony Friends" with the first person's name, for example "Samira". The box is editable. Your edit stays while you are on that card.
4. **Press "Copy message".** Do **not** press **Open in WhatsApp** for the other friends: it opens the chat of the **one number saved on the group**, which is the wrong person for everyone else.
5. **Open that person's own chat in WhatsApp** (search their name or number) and **paste**.
6. **Check the name** (see the checks below), then press **Send**.
7. **Go back, change the name to the next friend**, and repeat steps 4 to 6. Tick the tracker after each one.
8. Only when **everyone** in the group has the message, press ✓ **Mark as sent**. The website keeps **one tick per group**, not per person, so do not tick early. If you must stop halfway, press **Stop** (do not tick) and carry on later from your tracker.

Name check, every single time, before you press Send

Two names must match: the name **inside the message** ("Dear Samira") and the **contact name at the top of the WhatsApp chat**. When you copy and paste again and again, it is very easy to send "Dear Samira" to Kasun. If they do not match, stop. Delete the message and fix it.

SHARED CODE · SEPARATE PHONES

Cautions, tracker and the future fix

Mistakes to watch for

- **Wrong name pasted.** The text still says the previous person's name. Read the first line of every message before sending.
- **Similar names or the wrong chat.** Samira, Sameera and Samiran look alike. Compare letter by letter with the name at the top of the WhatsApp chat.
- **Never use WhatsApp "Forward".** It keeps the old name, and marks the message "Forwarded". Always copy and paste a fresh message.
- **Do not send the code and the invitation together.** The same rule applies to each friend: Step 1 first, then Step 2 to the same person.
- **Step 4 (table):** the message lists everyone's tables. You can keep it, or cut it down to that person's own line so they only see their own table.

> **They share one code, so they can see each other**
> Everyone using the same code can see who else is in the group on the RSVP page. If that is not wanted, the group can be split into separate invitations, one per person, each with its own code and number (Guests → Add guest, "Individual"). Then the normal method works with no copy and paste. This is your decision to make with Tharindu.

Printable tracker (one per group)

Group name: _____ Code: _____

Person's name	Step 1 Invitation	Step 2 Code	Step 3 Reminder	Step 4 Table	Name checked ✓
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

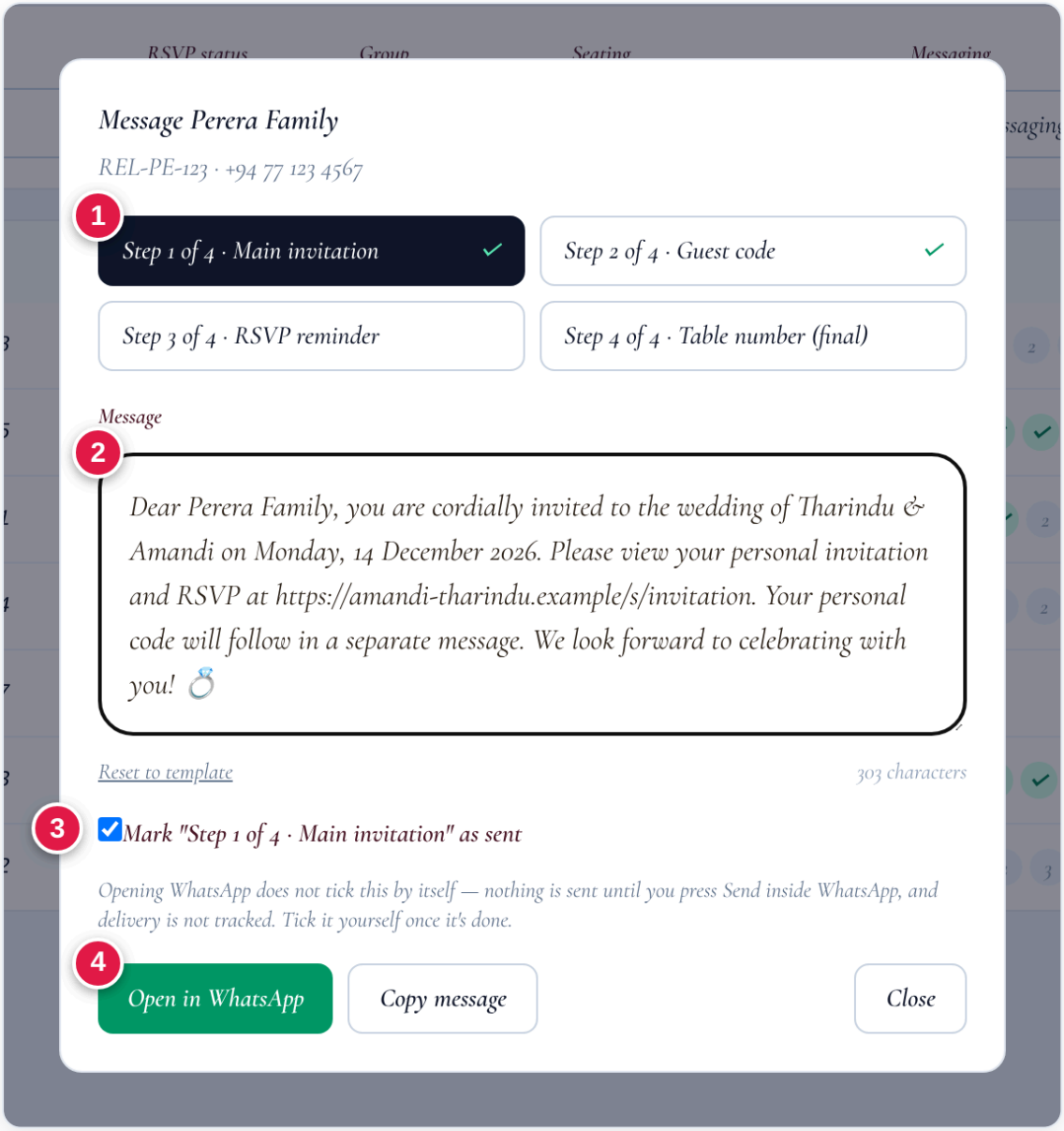
When every box in a column is ticked, press ✓ **Mark as sent** on the website for that level. Then the website's progress matches yours.

IMPROVEMENT TO BUILD LATER · FOR THE DEVELOPER

What is missing: a WhatsApp number for **each person** in a group, not just one for the whole group.
What it would do: the Messages page would step through **each person** in the group, open **their own** chat, and fill in **their own first name** ("Dear Samira"), so no typing or copy and paste is needed. Ticks would be kept **per person**, not per group.
What it needs: a change to the database (a number for each person) and to the Guests and Messages pages. Until this is built and tested, use the manual method above.

ONE GUEST Sending to just one guest

Good for a quick message, a late guest, or fixing a mistake. Go to **Guests** and click the guest's WhatsApp number.



The pop-up for one guest

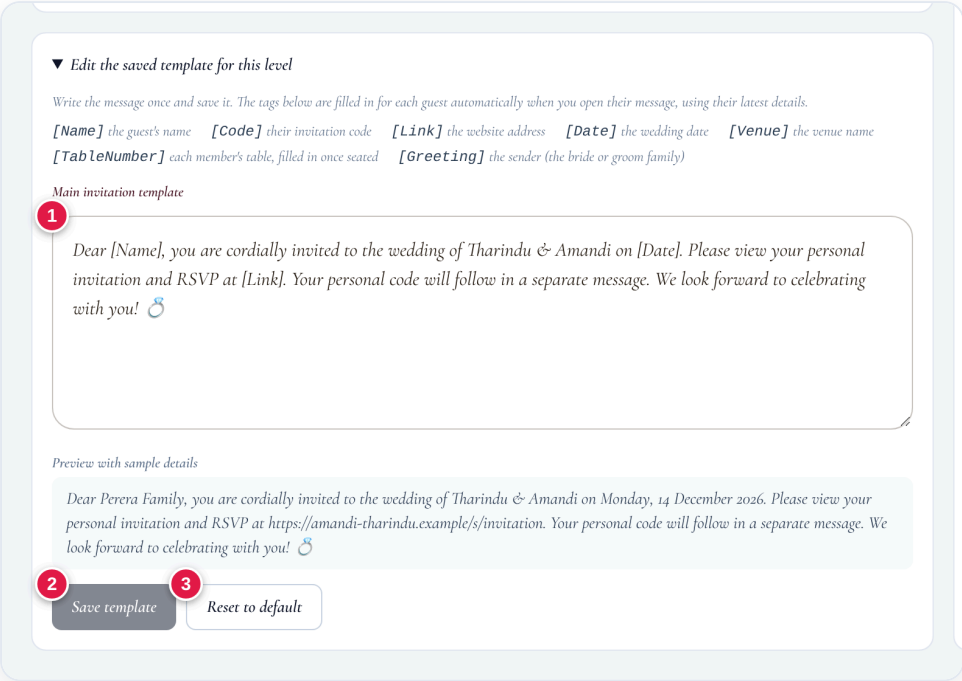
1. Four tabs, one per step. A ✓ on a tab means it is already ticked.
2. The message, ready to send. You can edit it.
3. Tick **"Mark … as sent"** after you press Send in WhatsApp. **Untick** it if you ticked by mistake or need to send again.
4. **Open in WhatsApp** opens their chat.

> **Remember**
> Here the tick is a checkbox you control. Opening WhatsApp does not tick it.

WORDING

Changing what the messages say

On the Messages page, pick the level, then open **“Edit the saved template for this level”**.



The template editor

1. Change the words in the box. The **Preview** below shows a sample.
2. **Save template** keeps your changes.
3. **Reset to default** brings back the original words.

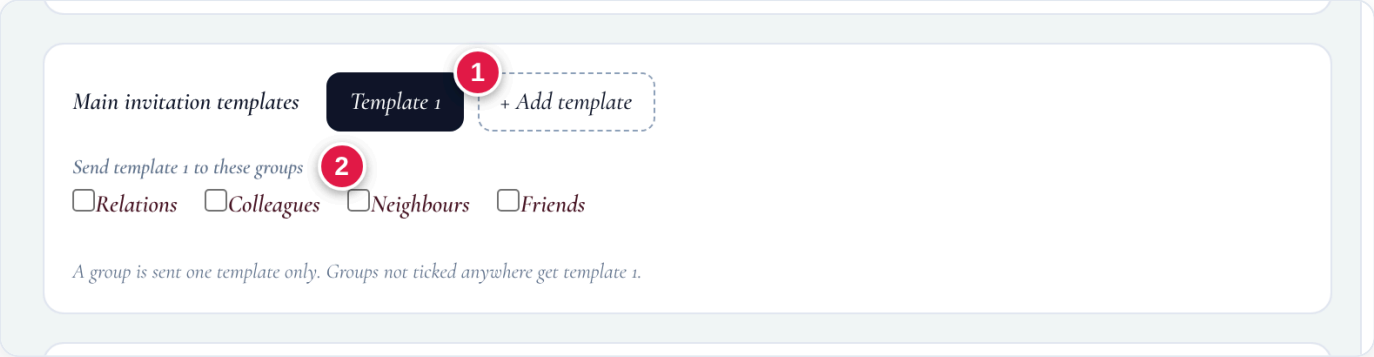
Tags: they fill in by themselves for each guest

Tag	Becomes	Tag	Becomes
`[Name]`	the guest’s name	`[Date]`	the wedding date
`[Code]`	their code	`[Venue]`	the venue
`[Link]`	the website address	`[TableNumber]`	their table(s)
`[Greeting]`	who it is from		

Keep `[Code]` out of Step 1.
That is the whole reason the code has its own message.

Different invitation wording for different groups

Step 1 can keep up to **4 templates**, for example a formal one for relatives and a casual one for friends.



Template buttons and the group tick-boxes

1. **+ Add template** makes a copy of Template 1 to edit.
2. Tick the groups that should get the open template. A group gets **one** template only. Unticked groups get Template 1.

Wording is shared with your partner's admin account, so tell each other before you edit.

HELP If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
A guest is missing from the list	They may have no WhatsApp number (see the “skipped” count), may already be ticked, or a filter is hiding them. Try Audience = **Everyone** and Group = **All groups**.
I sent it but forgot Mark as sent	Open the guest on the **Guests** page (click their number) and tick the step. Do **not** send twice.
I ticked someone by mistake	**Guests** page → click their number → untick that step.
WhatsApp does not open	Allow pop-ups for the site in your browser. Nothing was saved. Try again.
Emoji look like “□”	You are probably on a computer or WhatsApp Web. Use your phone, or press **Copy message** and paste into WhatsApp.
“No usable WhatsApp number”	The number is wrong or too short. Fix it in **Guests → Edit**. Sri Lankan numbers like 071 234 5678 are fine.
I sent the code before the invitation	It is okay. Send Step 1 afterwards and tick it. The order matters for safety, not for the website working.
One code, but each friend has their own phone	Use the manual method: change the name in the box, press **Copy message**, paste into that person’s own chat, check the name, send. Do **not** press Open in WhatsApp for them. See “One code, many people”.
The page says “Unauthorized”	Sign in again at your website address followed by `/admin`.

The golden rules

1. **Step 1 first, then Step 2 right after.** The invitation never carries the code.
2. **Send once per invitation**, not once per person in the family.
3. **Send in WhatsApp, then press ✓ Mark as sent.** Opening WhatsApp alone does not tick.
4. **Do not send Step 4 until the family is “All seated”.**
5. **Never post a guest’s code in a group chat.**
6. **Shared code, separate phones: check the name before every Send.** The name in the message must match the WhatsApp chat.

